Music

Hymns & Spirituals
Folk Songs
Afternoon Listening
Composer Study
Sol-fa

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Alveary

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About the Course

This course includes the following topic(s): Composer Study, Hymns & Spirituals, Folk Songs, Sol-fa: Level 2, Afternoon Listening

About Hymns & Spirituals
Students sing hymns and spirituals to build their faith and appreciation of God's work across time. Hymns and spirituals are connected to the historical time period as appropriate.

About Folk Songs
Students sing folk songs connected to the time period (1800-1900).

About Composer Study
In this course students are immersed into the 19th century via it's composers, instruments, and musical performances. Term 1 focuses on several influential instruments/instrument families, including valved brass, the saxophone, and the guitar, and the musicians that made them famous. In Term 2, students will grow to know and love the Norwegian Romantic composer, Edvard Grieg. Students conclude the year in Term 3 with the comic operas of Gilbert & Sullivan and their choice between two composers who turned what they saw or heard into music: Modest Mussorgsky and Thomas ("Blind Tom") Wiggins.

About Sol-fa: Level 2
Learn the sol-fa syllables, concepts of rhythm and meter, and how to read music. Video lessons are provided with the lesson plans.

Skills Focus: Rhythm, meter, sol-fa syllables and hand signs, ear test.

Hymns & Spirituals
The Christian hymn and spiritual tradition is incredibly rich, and it is vanishing from many churches. In addition to bringing a much-needed moment of peace to your day, hymns can also introduce students to important theological ideas and church liturgy.

Folk Songs
The purpose of learning folk songs is twofold: to increase students' enjoyment of music and to situate folk music in its historical context in an effort to give students a richer understanding of the times and places that birthed the songs. A musical score is sometimes included for songs, but does not always exactly match the audio used, since folk songs are primarily oral songs and often take many different forms. Studying folk music helps students grow deep roots in our shared heritage and gives insight into historical events from the perspective of the people who were there.

Composer Study
"Music is no isolated thing. Its forms, colors, and expressive qualities do not spring from nowhere; they come out of life itself. Often, of course, they are to be enjoyed for themselves alone, in the concert hall or in one's armchair. But music also reflects human experiences, hopes, and struggles. It may give an insight into the individual and society, into the lives of those far removed from our own in time and place—an insight no other art can provide in this exact way."
~Elie Siegmeister

Placement & Combining Tips

All music lessons except sol-fa are shared between Grades 2-12, making them ideal lessons for multi-age groups.

Composer Study
These Composer Study lessons are shared across grades 2-12 with extensions provided for older students. Students in Grades 2-3 with no classical music background may choose to take

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Intro to Music Appreciation first, but the composers in this rotation are particularly accessible for a wide range of ages.

Sol-fa: Level 2
Grade 3 students with no experience with sol-fa or sight-reading music may start with Level 1 or 2. Older students should start with Level 2.

Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
1-12	Hymns & Spirituals 1 time/week 10 min	Our Hymns, Our Heritage
1-12	Folk Songs 1 time/week 10 min	Like a Bird: The Art of the American Slave Song
1-12	Afternoon Listening 1+ time/week 10 min	
2-12	Composer Study 1 time/week 10 min 1 time/week 15 min	Playlist for the Year Mussorgsky's Pictures at an Exhibition Song in a Rainstorm: The Story of Musical Prodigy Thomas Blind Tom Wiggins
3+	Sol-fa: Level 2 1 time/week 10 min	Sol-fa Level 2 Audio/Video Lessons
	Shared course resources	*Hymns, Spirituals, & Folk Songs PDF* *Our Work: Grade 3*

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Music: Level 2				
Sol-fa: Level 2	Hymns & Spirituals	Folk Songs	Composer Study Afternoon Listening	

Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Hymns & Spirituals
☐ Bookmark the Alveary hymns, spirituals, and folk song playlist for the year, or create your own YouTube, Spotify, or Amazon playlist if desired.

Composer Study
• Charlotte Mason often included more music in the program than could be covered in the lesson time. While we choose segments that fit the length of the lesson, students will develop a relationship with the term's music insofar as it is a part of their daily atmosphere.
• The YouTube playlist contains nearly the whole year's music, though lessons will occasionally have extra links to historical or musical information. This playlist is mostly used in the lessons as videos are often chosen for visual and sometimes historical interest. You will also find a spotify playlist of the term's music in Quick Links for easy afternoon listening.
• Use the year's playlist to listen to previous and current pieces in the afternoons, and explore the Extra Helpings as interested (ideas which relate directly to a lesson are usually included nearby, while more general resources and activities are listed on the Extra Helpings page). Grade 5+ extensions are also usually appropriate as Extra Helpings for interested younger students.

Sol-fa: Level 2

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☐ Bookmark Sol-fa playlists (see Quick Links). If you create a free account on the SoundCloud app, the Sol-Fa lessons become downloadable for offline use.

Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ View Book List Details

Music: Level 2

- Our Work: Grade 3
- Hymns, Spirituals, & Folk Songs PDF

Hymns & Spirituals



Our Hymns, Our Heritage

Folk Songs



Like a Bird: The Art of the American Slave Song

Composer Study

- Playlist for the Year



Mussorgsky's Pictures at an Exhibition



Song in a Rainstorm: The Story of Musical Prodigy Thomas Blind Tom Wiggins

Sol-fa: Level 2

- Sol-fa Level 2 Audio/Video Lessons

Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ View Basic Supplies
∞ View Supply List Details

Sol-fa: Level 2



Glockenspiel

Quick Links

Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.

Music: Level 2

∞ Extra Helpings

Hymns & Spirituals

∞ Hymns, Spirituals & Folk Songs Spotify Playlist

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- Hymns, Spirituals & Folk Songs Youtube Playlist
- Hymns, Spirituals, & Folk Songs PDF
- Musical Terms Appendix

Folk Songs

- Hymns, Folk Songs, & Spirituals Youtube Playlist
- Hymns, Folk Songs, & Spirituals Spotify Playlist
- Musical Terms Appendix

Composer Study

- Extra Resource: Classics for Kids Musical Dictionary
- Composer Study Playlist (YouTube)
- Composer Study Playlist (Spotify)
- Apppendix: Musical Vocabulary
- Century Chart
- Foundations (See Section 12: Music)

Sol-fa: Level 2

- Warm-Ups (Audio)
- Warm-Ups (Video)
- Sol-fa Level 2 Folder
- Blank Staff Paper

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Music: Level 2

How To Teach

Recap

• Specific recap questions are often suggested in the day's plans; ask students what they remember from the last lesson. If nothing comes to mind at first, tell them to give themselves another minute or two and to keep thinking. Our brains are amazing and can usually recall the previous lesson with a minute of effort. Refrain from doing the work of remembering yourself if you are leading the lessons.

• For composer study, a recap might look like a brief discussion about the name or sound of the piece you listened to previously.

• For hymns and folk songs, this might be an effort to hum the melody or recite the words of the song you're currently learning.

• For sol-fa, it might be a quick explanation of the sol-fa syllable you learned or a tricky rhythm or interval you were working to master.

• If students have difficulty recalling, teachers might try showing them a picture or sharing something that the teacher remembers. This will often refresh their memory enough to allow them to recall.

• If students still cannot recall anything from the last reading, then teachers may consider continuing anyway or repeating the last lesson.

Introduce

• Prepare to listen to the day's musical selection by inviting students to consider an interesting musical or historical idea in the lesson. Perhaps it's a unique word, rhythm, instrument, or piece of historical background. You might introduce it by the way, or read a selection of a composer's bio or a brief article to students.

Listen & Sing

• Listen to the day's musical selection.

• Composer study lessons will usually have you listen to a piece of music for 3-8 minutes. If students have a difficult time listening for the duration of the lesson, stop the music at their limit.

• Some students might draw, color, or engage in a handicraft while listening to help extend their listening time. Students who have a difficult time sitting still or listening may benefit from: a fidget of their choice, such as a piece of putty or clay or an afghan; flexible positioning, such as a wobble seat or inverted sitting; or sensory modulation, such as a weighted vest or blanket or adjustment of light, temperature, or sound.

• Hymn, folk song, or sol-fa lessons will sometimes have you listen to a part of the song and then practice echoing back the melody and/or words.

Discuss

• Composer Study: Talk about the musical selection you heard. What stood out to you? What did you notice? What did it make you wonder? Did it remind you of anything? Discuss the tempo, the sound of the music, the instruments used, the volume, and the mood. Why do you think the composer wrote it the way he did?

• Hymns, Spirituals, & Folk Songs: What lines strike you particularly? Is there a rhyme scheme to the lyrics? Is there a progression to each stanza? If you were to add a verse to the song, what would you add? If you took a verse out, how do you think it would change the song? Do the

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melody and words go together? Why or why not?

• Sol-fa: Take a minute to reflect on what you learned in the lesson. Write down any notes you want to remember and practice any particular exercises that were tricky.



Connect

• At the end of the lesson, think about how the day's musical selection connects to other books, subjects, characters in history, etc.

• You might copy down a stanza of a hymn in your Commonplace or Copywork book, read a bit more about the history behind a piece of music, jot down a noteworthy date in your Book of Centuries, or discuss a broader question raised in the lesson.

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Music: Level 2

Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.

Term 1

WEEK 1

⬚ **10m Sol-fa: Level 2 - Lesson 1**
Our Bodies - Instruments

→ INTRO
This year, we'll learn the basics of sol-fa, singing from printed music, and musical ideas about rhythm and meter.
Warm up your voice.
∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups
∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

→ VIEW & PRACTICE
Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed.
∞ Video Link: Lesson 1.1

WEEK 1

⬚ **10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 1**
How Firm a Foundation

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage, Our Work Book, and/or Music Selections Booklet

→ INTRO
Our first hymn this year is called "How Firm a Foundation." What is a foundation, and what do you think this hymn will be about?

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE
Today, focus on getting familiar with the hymn. Read the words aloud and listen to the full song. Note that various recordings sometimes use the older "thee" rather than "you" and annotate your lyrics depending on the recording you use. Notice, talk about, and look up any unfamiliar words.
∞ Music Links: How Firm a Foundation (YouTube or Spotify)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
Learn the history of the song from Our Hymns, Our Heritage.
"Text and Tune" p.136

• EXTRA HELPING
Look at early copies of Rippon's hymnal. What differences and similarities do you notice between it and hymnals today? If interested, read the original hymn (note the extra verses which are less common today) and the prefaces.
∞ **Book Links:** 1801 and 1828 versions

• AFTERNOON LISTENING
Use your preferred recording to listen to the hymn in the afternoons, evenings, or anytime! The more you spend time with it, the more the words will sink into your head and your heart.

• IMPORTANT DATES
"How Firm a Foundation" published in Rippon's hymnal (1787 AD).

WEEK 1

⬚ **10m Folk Songs - Lesson 1**
Steal Away

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF, Like a Bird

→ INTRO
• The word "steal" usually means to take something that isn't yours. Can you think of any other meanings the word has?
• Tell what you think this sentence means: "Let's steal away now and tell them what we saw!"

→ READ & DISCUSS
Our first folk song for the year is called "Steal Away to Jesus." Its history is somewhat debated. Some think that Nat Turner was one of the first to sing it. Others tell the story of Wallace Willis and how the Reverend Alexander Reid heard Willis singing "Steal Away" (and Swing Low, Sweet Chariot) and told the Jubilee Singers, a famous singing group, about his songs in 1871. It's often hard to trace the history of songs that were orally composed and passed along to others!

Like a Bird p.29
∞ Article Link: History Article 1 or History Article 2

★ TEACHER NOTE
Feel free to choose your own version of Steal Away to learn. Just know that the lyrics vary widely, so another audio or video is unlikely to match the words in your Our Work or Music books.

• AFTERNOON LISTENING
Be sure to listen to the term's songs throughout the week!

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Music: Level 2

Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.

Term 1

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS
Refer to your Our Work/Music PDF lyrics as you listen.
∞ Music Links: Steal Away (YouTube or Spotify)

WEEK 1

⬚ **15m Composer Study - Lesson 1**
Music in the 19th Century

→ INTRO
• What (if anything) comes to mind when you think about the 1800s and particularly music in the 1800s? Jot down any notes in your notebook or share with a friend.

• In term 1, we'll explore some instruments that characterized this century and then get to know a few particular composers and musicians in later terms.

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS
One instrument that spans all cultures and times is the human voice, but each time and place features it in different ways. Opera became particularly popular in the 1800s, and some became huge productions that showcased the flexibility, beauty, and power of the voice in various ways. Today's piece is an aria from an opera called "La Donna del Lago" or "The Lady of the Lake" by Gioachino Rossini, which was based on a poem by Sir Walter Scott. Even though the words are in Italian, see if you can guess the emotion of the piece as you listen in this lesson and over the week on your own time.

∞ Video Link (YouTube): Tanti Affetti
Time Marker: 0:0-5:06 or whole piece if time allows

• What kind of feeling do you think this piece communicates? Why?
• How does this piece show off the beauty, power, or flexibility of the human voice?

→ (GRADE 5+) READ & NARRATE
∞ Article Link: 19th Century Classical Music

★ TEACHER TIP
Musical terms are defined throughout the lessons, but an appendix with all the terms and definitions for the year is also provided in Quick Links for your convenience. Reference as desired.

Instruments are ideal for Book of Century, History Chart, or music notebook sketches. Encourage students to add to their notebooks as desired. Dates for key people and events are also provided throughout the plans.
∞ **PDF Link:** Century Chart

• **IMPORTANT DATES**
La Donna del Lago first performed (Italy, 1819AD)

• **EXTRA HELPING**
∞ **Video Link:** How Vocal Chords Work

WEEK 2

⬚ **10m Sol-fa: Level 2 - Lesson 2**
High and Low Sounds

→ RECAP
Warm up your voice and review concepts from previous lesson.
∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups
∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

→ VIEW & PRACTICE
Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed.
∞ Video Link: Lesson 1.2

WEEK 2

⬚ **10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 2**
How Firm a Foundation (cont.)

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Music PDF or Our Work Book, Bible

→ RECAP
What is the name of the hymn for this term, and what is it about? Tell anything else you remember about its history.

→ SING
Practice the tune by first listening to a verse, then humming the next two.
∞ Music Links: How Firm a Foundation Full Song (YouTube or Spotify)

★ TEACHER TIP
If teaching in a classroom setting, assign verses to various students to keep this part of the lesson from taking too long.

• **EXTRA HELPING**
More on the song's history and how the author used bible verses in his composition. Note the additional verse
∞ **Video Link:** Hymn Story, Analysis, Performance

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Term 1

→ READ & DISCUSS
Let's focus on the lyrics a bit more. Read the whole song aloud, then look up the Bible verses below (mentioned last week in your hymnal) and tell what you notice about the images, ideas, or even direct words that the hymn writer used from each verse.

- Isaiah 41:10 (Stanza 2)
- Isaiah 43:2 (Stanza 3 & 4)
- Zechariah 13:9 (Stanza 4)
- John 10:27-29, Romans 8:38-39, Hebrews 13:5-6 (Stanza 5)

→ (OPTIONAL) COPYWORK (GRADES 4+)
Write one of the Bible verses above underneath your hymn lyrics or in your copywork book.

WEEK 2

⬚ **10m Folk Songs - Lesson 2**
Steal Away (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF, United States Atlas or a Globe

→ RECAP
What do you remember about the history of "Steal Away"?

→ SING
Listen to the full song, paying attention to the lyrics. Then listen again and hum along.
∞ Music Links: Steal Away (YouTube or Spotify)

→ READ OR VIEW
Steal Away became an enormously popular song across the United States and the world because of the Fisk Jubilee Singers. Fisk University was founded in 1866, right after the Civil War ended with the Emancipation Proclamation. Students who had previously had limited access to higher education because of slavery and poverty flocked to its doors. But a few years later, the school was struggling financially, and many feared it would have to close. However, relief came from an unexpected source—one of the school's leaders organized a group of the school's talented singers and set up a series of concerts. Initially, they sang classical and popular songs familiar to their white audiences, but eventually the students began also singing the spirituals that they had sung during the years they were enslaved. These spirituals, like Steal Away and Swing Low, Sweet Chariot, skyrocketed the Fisk Jubilee Singers and the school to fame, and both still exist today! Read or watch more about the Jubilee Singers and listen to a recording of Swing Low, Sweet Chariot from 1909 with the remaining time!
∞ Article Link: Jubilee Singers Article
or
∞ Video Link: Jubilee Singers Video

→ LISTEN (OPTIONAL)
∞ Audio Link: Swing Low, Sweet Chariot

• EXTRA HELPING
View the Extra Helpings page for books, documentaries, and resources on the Jubilee Singers!

WEEK 2

⬚ **15m Composer Study - Lesson 2**
Different Types of Vocal Poetry

PREP: Notebooking sound can be a little tricky. Listen to John Muir Laws talk about capturing birdsong in his notebook to give students ideas on how to sketch some of what they hear in today's musical piece(s) and others throughout the year.
∞ Video Link: Birdsong in your nature journal

• TERMINOLOGY
Bel canto opera: literally "beautiful singing" and a style of opera featuring the voice, which focuses on conveying the emotion of a piece through the singing rather than simply moving the plot forward.

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Music: Level 2

Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.

Term 1

→ RECAP
Describe the piece we started listening to last lesson.

→ INTRO
Musical performances in the 19th century became both larger and smaller. Operas and other theatrical performances became more accessible to the middle class and not just the wealthy, but so did the private musical performances in homes or smaller venues. Arias like Tanti Affetti showcased the voice on the large stages, while intimate songs, setting a poem to music with just a piano and voice, explored the power of the human voice to express emotion in these smaller settings. In Germany, several composers wrote so many of this second type of song that they created their own genre of song (called "lieder") and became the standard that others followed.

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS
Notice any musical features common in bel canto operas, such as trills, melismas, coloratura passages, and even appoggiaturas as you listen to the vocal fireworks that end this aria. You may want to pause the video periodically to jot down what you notice/hear in your notebook. Don't feel like you need to capture the whole aria - just a few key moments that strike you as great!

∞ Video Link (YouTube): Tanti Affetti
Time Marker: 5:06-end

• What did you notice?

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS
∞ Video Link (YouTube): Über allen Gipfeln ist Ruh
Time Marker: 0:00-1:52

• (Grades 5+) Discuss or sketch the differences in mood, sound quality, and anything else you notice about these two pieces.

Coloratura: literally "colorful" singing with fast-moving passages, trills, and vocal leaps.

Trills: moving between two notes very fast.

Melisma: multiple notes sung on one syllable.

Advanced Listening:
Appoggiatura, Chromatic scales
∞ Video Link: What is appoggiatura?

Lieder: German art songs usually featuring piano and voice, where the pianist and singer are equal partners working to interpret and showcase the emotion of the poetry.

WEEK 3 ⬚ **10m Sol-fa: Level 2 - Lesson 3**
Rhythms

→ RECAP
Warm up your voice and review concepts from previous lesson.
∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups
∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

→ VIEW & PRACTICE
Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed.
∞ Video Link: Lesson 1.3

WEEK 3 ⬚ **10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 3**
How Firm a Foundation (cont.)

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Music PDF or Our Work Book

→ RECAP
Sing the tune of How Firm a Foundation on "hoo" and read the words aloud. Pay attention to the meaning and punctuation as you read.

→ SING & DISCUSS
Today, listen to a line of the song, then pause the video and echo it back, working your way line by line through the song. This will help you focus on each line of the song, not just the ones that come easily to you.
∞ Music Links: How Firm a Foundation Full Song (YouTube or Spotify)

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Term 1

• What images or lines in the song do you like best?

→ COPYWORK (GRADE 4+)
Copy a line of the melody into your music journal and (if you are taking sol-fa), see if you can label the notes with the sol-fa syllables. Hint: it is written in the key of G, and the first note is "So." Count up how many different sol-fa syllables you used in the song [there should be five]. This hymn is written using the pentatonic scale (often a major scale omitting fa and ti). Many other hymns (like Amazing Grace) are also written with only these five different sol-fa syllables. Explore Extra Helpings to explore a music theory rabbit hole on pentatonic music.

WEEK 3

⬚ **10m Folk Songs - Lesson 3**
Steal Away (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF, World Map/Globe/Google Maps

→ RECAP
Can you hum the tune of "Steal Away"?

→ SING & PRACTICE
Listen to the full song. Then listen again and try to sing along with the recording when the singers repeat the first four lines.
∞ Music Links: Steal Away (YouTube or Spotify)

→ MAPWORK
The initial group of Jubilee singers disbanded in 1878 after six strenuous years touring across North America and Europe, but a new group came together and began touring again in 1894, singing everywhere from Canada to Kolkata (then Calcutta), from New England to New Zealand.

View the article and map to get a general sense of the choir's tour and look up as many of the places mentioned as time allows. Note that some cities have been renamed.
∞ Article Link: Jubilee Singer Travels (start reading at the paragraph under the map which describes the tour)

WEEK 3

⬚ **15m Composer Study - Lesson 3**
Vocal Poetry cont.

→ RECAP
Recall any new musical terms you learned last lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE
Let's learn a bit more about the person who composed the song we started learning last lesson.
∞ Article Link: All About Fanny Mendelssohn

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS
"Goethe's Wandrers Nachtlied II (Über allen Gipfeln) is considered by many to be the most perfect lyric in the German language. The poet is supposed to have written the poem on the evening of 6 September 1780 onto the wall of a lodge on top of the Kickelhahn Mountain near Ilmenau, where he supposedly spent the night" (Interlude article)

English Translation:
"Over all summits
Is peace,
In all treetops
You feel
Hardly a breath:
The birds are silent in the woods.

★ TEACHER NOTE
If your students are having a hard time connecting with Über allen Gipfeln, feel free to spend the whole lessons with Soundararajam, the second piece.

• AFTERNOON LISTENING
Assigned selections fit in the lesson, but students will develop a relationship with the term's music insofar as it is a part of their daily atmosphere. Use the year's playlist YouTube and/or Spotify playlists to listen to previous and current pieces in the afternoons.

• EXTRA HELPING
Explore more lieder and more about Carnactic music and Muttuswami Dikshitar in extra helpings.

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Term 1

Only wait, soon
You too shall rest"

Think of these lyrics as you listen again to Fanny's lied (pronounced "leed").

∞ Video Link (YouTube): Über allen Gipfeln ist Ruh
∞ Reference Link: About Goethe's poem (explore the other lieder based on this poem as desired).

• How do you hear the music trying to paint a sound picture of the poetry? Think about the dynamics (loud/soft, smooth/rough), melody, and rhythm.

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS (OPTIONAL GRADES 1-4)
• Across the world from Germany, musicians were setting poetry to song in India as well. These songs were called "kritis" and are renowned for the same things as lieder: the balance of melody, rhythm, and poetry in their use of the human voice as an instrument.
• Begin listening to this famous kritis from the early 19th century, saving a minute or two for discussion.
• Optional: As you listen, sketch a veena in your music notebook. In the same way the piano accompanies the voice in German lider, the veena is the main instrument accompanying the voice in Carnatic music.

∞ Image Link: Veena
∞ Video Link (YouTube): Soundararajam by Dikshitar

• What similarities and differences do you hear in the way the voice is featured?

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